



No more editing of obscure conf files with `sudo` privileges. If you still want to enable the `root` account, follow this procedure. In the terminal, type `$ sudo passwd root`.

This will prompt you for a new root password (after you provide your password to get `sudo` access), and you can set it here. After this you can use `root` as the user-name and set the password to get root access. If you want to again disable it in future, you can lock it as follows

```
$sudo passwd -l root
```

Revert button locations

Latest editions of Ubuntu have moved the Close, Minimise and Maximise buttons to the left of the title bar. Launch `gconf-editor` by typing it in the 'Run Application' window. Browse to `Apps > metacity > general`, look for "button_layout" on the right panel. Change the value in the "button_layout"

from close, minimize, maximize: to menu: minimize, maximize, close. A restart should bring your things back in order.

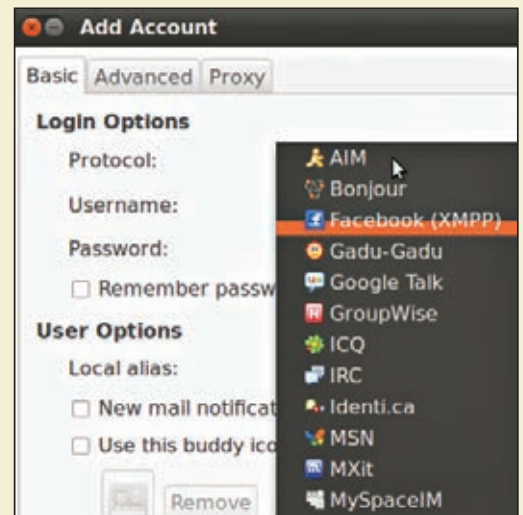
Reduce Wait time

After full installation, Ubuntu is set to be the default operating system to boot up if no key is pressed within 10 seconds on a multi-boot system (say with Windows). You can do that easily with a graphical application (No more messing with `/X11/boot/grub/menu.lst`). Install `startupmanager` either from synaptics or via terminal by typing `$ sudo apt-get install startupmanager`

Once installed, it can be found at `System > Administration > Startup Manager`. Not only can you change the default operating system and Timeout, you can adjust resolution, colour depth and even create a rescue floppy in case you ever get stuck.

Toggle icons on Desktop

By default an icon for every partition on your hard drive and every storage device attached to your system will be displayed on your desktop. If you don't prefer that and want to save that space, then open `gconf-editor` and go to `apps > nautilus > desktop`. Now uncheck `volumes_` visible and close the window.



Now chat on Facebook from a Desktop Client

Restore without Rebooting

Ubuntu separates the Graphical applications from the core system, and if you're stuck with a system that just hung on you, you can still revive it without a restart. Press `[Ctrl] + [Alt] + Backspace` to kill the Xserver, and get back to the login screen. This will kill all your graphical applications and command line applications specific to your username and bring you back to the login screen. This will leave the server running as root intact, and will be faster than a complete reboot. To enable this shortcut, navigate to `System > Preferences > Keyboard`. Choose the "Layouts" tab and click the "Options" button. Over there select "Key sequence to kill the X server" and enable "Control + Alt + Backspace".

Yakuake

If you find yourself frequenting the terminal, then Yakuake is the perfect solution for you. Yakuake stands

for Yet Another Q(K)uake Style Terminal Emulator, it is small app, which at the press of a hotkey drops down a terminal window

over your screen, exactly like Quake. You can customise the hotkey, transparency and a host of other options. The default is `[F12]`. To install type `$ sudo apt-get install yakuake`.

Stop a hung application

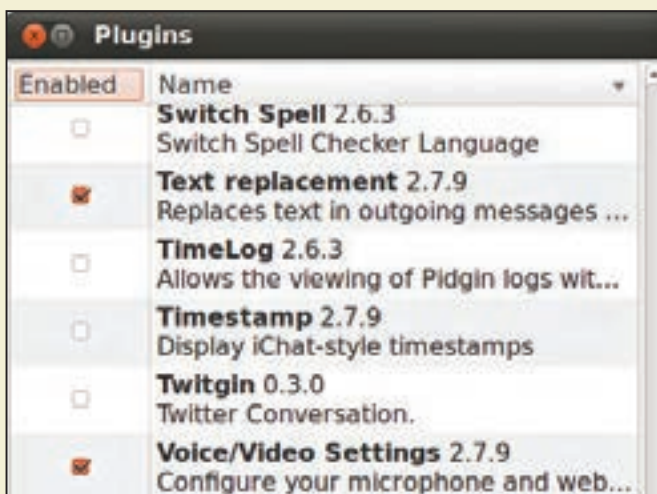
If an application gets hung, and even the force quit option is not working, open a terminal and type `$ killall <appname>`.

If you don't know the application name, you can type in the first few letters, and press `[Tab]` a couple of times to auto complete. If the above still doesn't work try `$ ps -e | grep <appname>`.

This will display the app with its corresponding process id. Then type `$ kill -9 <Process Id>` and it will shutdown the application. You can also enter any subset of the application name, and it will find it for you.

Pidgin

Pidgin is a multi-protocol chat client where you can log on to multiple IM services



Selectively add functionality